

ECLIPSE:

A Developer-friendly Tool

Eclipse is an open source framework that provides multiple services and built-in support to Java developers, to help them build GUI and non-GUI based applications. It supports binding of applications to other applications with great flexibility and robustness.



Every day, we are faced with numerous challenges and introduced to many sophisticated technologies to simplify or speed up our work. There are a plethora of tools (basically applications that complete a task) that offer simple and quick solutions to help us towards our goals. These tools have become an inseparable part of our lives - right from the wake up caller, diet planner, reminder, time manager, goal manager, to-do-lister, music player, photo editor, file manager, and financial adviser, to the modern day blogger tool, collaborator, social networking tools, etc. The list is only limited by the boundaries of human creativity.

Trip to Toolville

To encourage budding developers to explore their area of expertise and to promote emerging entrepreneurs, there are companies coming up with a variety of APIs recommended for use by students, professionals and SMEs. For any project that's being started from scratch, we seek the right combination of tools to design, code, integrate, test and deploy. The Integrated Development Environment (IDE) is a powerful set of tools which provides a single portal to organise resources, as well as develop, integrate, build, run

and debug programs. There are many IDEs that cater to tool development in specific programming languages.

Let's walk through some popular open source frameworks that help users in building tools.

wxWidgets: wxWidgets offers a cross-platform tools library for creating C++ GUI applications. wxWidgets applications run on all major OS platforms like Windows, UNIX, Mac and mobile platforms including Windows Mobile, iPhone SDK and embedded GTK+. It has popular language bindings for Python, Perl, Ruby and many others. Unlike other cross-platform toolkits, wxWidgets gives its applications a truly native look and feel, because it uses the platform's native API rather than emulating the GUI. The Google Drive system desktop client uses wxPython.

Tcl/Tk: Let's split these as Tcl (Tool Command Language) and Tk (Tool Kit). Tcl is a scripting language with each operation defined as a command. Tk is an open source, cross-platform widget toolkit that provides a library of widgets to develop desktop applications with a canvas, frames, labels, buttons, menus, text, etc. Tk has been ported to run on most flavours of Linux, Mac OS, UNIX, and Microsoft Windows. The Tk toolkit is a programming environment for creating